

MICROSOFT WORD

The most popular word processor in use by everybody with a rich set of features. Yet, there are many aspects of the word processor that you might not be aware of. So, work smarter and faster with these tips

Working with Toolbars

Working all day with a word processor can be quite demanding. And staring at a cluttered screen doesn't help matters any. Wouldn't it be nice if you could customise your toolbars, and place them strategically on your monitor screen?



Arrange the toolbars as per your liking

Apart from being easier on the eye, this would also give you more space on the desktop. Toolbars could be customised to display the buttons that are in frequent use. You can add, delete or copy buttons from the toolbars that come with Word.

Many of these customisations can be done using the [Alt] key. Buttons can be moved within the toolbar by pressing the [Alt] key and clicking on the button that's to be moved.

Keeping the mouse button pressed, drag the toolbar button to the new location. To delete a button, drag it off the toolbar. A button can be copied from one toolbar to another by pressing both [Alt] and [Ctrl] while dragging the button to a different toolbar.

Retrieving deleted text even after closing Word

You can clear text and bring it back using the 'spike' feature in Microsoft Word. Press [Ctrl] + [F3] after selecting the text or object that you want to clear. This will delete the text and append it to the spike. To retrieve the spike's contents and to

clear it, press [Ctrl] + [Shift] + [F3]. However, if you need to keep the contents in the spike after recalling them, select Insert > AutoText > AutoText. In the box labelled 'Enter AutoText Entries Here', scroll through and select the spike option. Clicking the Insert button will then paste the contents of the spike. This can be seen in the Preview window without clearing the spike.

Wondering what a spike is? Well, it's an AutoText Entry area in which Word stores deleted text. This is not to be confused with the Clipboard. Spike is available even after an application is closed, whereas matter on the Clipboard isn't.

Shrinking documents

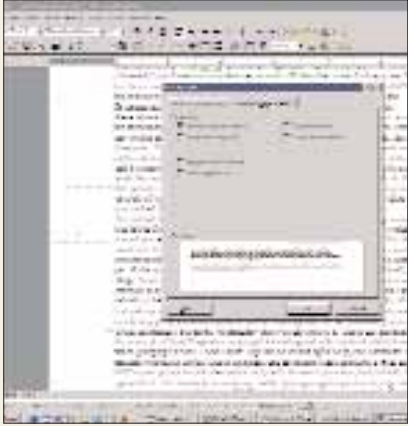
While typing a long document, it may happen that one or two lines of a paragraph slips to the next page. You might have wondered how to bring the lines to fit in the page. Here's the solution. You can use the 'Shrink to Fit' feature to fit everything on the page. Choose Print Preview and click on the Shrink to Fit button. Now your document is more compact—and you can feel happy at the thought that you've contributed your bit to preserving the environment by conserving paper.

Restoring graphics size

While taking screenshots you would normally paste them into your Word document directly, or after making some changes. Word fits these into compact frames and doesn't show the full size of the image embedded in the document. You can restore the original size of the image by using the [Ctrl] key. Press the [Ctrl] key while you double-click inside the image area. And behold, you have Pamela Anderson in all her glory!

Avoiding breaking of tables

The spillover mentioned while shrinking documents can affect tables also. Here's

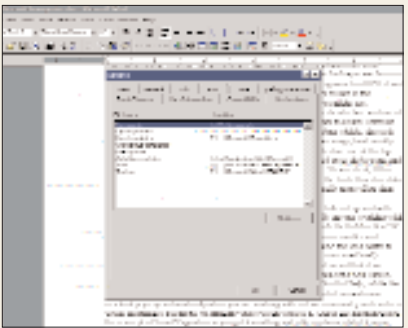


Use the 'Keep with next' option to keep paragraphs together

a handy tip to keep your tables intact. Select the first column of the table; choose Paragraph from the Format menu. Click the 'Line and Page Breaks' tab and check 'Keep with next'. Now you can be sure that your table doesn't spill over into the next page.

Changing the default save folder

You might not want to put all your eggs into one basket—or all your documents into the same folder. Word by default shows you the MyDocuments folder to save or to open files. You could modify this default Open/Save folder by making changes to Word's File Locations tab.



Specify the folder where you want to save your files

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